

ACT ONE, SCENE ONE

A bare stage. Torches burn along the wall.

HAMLET: Who's there?

FRANCISCO: Nay, answer me. Stand and unfold yourself.

HAMLET: Long live the king!

FRANCISCO: Bernardo?

BERNARDO: He.

FRANCISCO: You come most carefully upon your hour.

BERNARDO: 'Tis now struck twelve. Get thee to bed, Francisco.

FRANCISCO: For this relief much thanks. 'Tis bitter cold,
and I am sick at heart.

BERNARDO: Have you had quiet guard?

FRANCISCO: Not a mouse stirring.